security and increased cooperation in the areas of development and counter terrorism. An MoU on interconnecting electricity grids of the two countries, two MoUs on the transfer of sentenced persons and mutual legal assistance in criminal matters that aim at enhancing counter-terror cooperation, a pact on laying Talaimannar-Madhu rail link, and an MoU on special projects and community learning centre by SEWA were signed.

With Bangladesh, India maintained cordial relations. Bangladesh Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina visited India in early January 2010. India extended a line of credit worth one billion dollars on the terms of Asian Development Bank for infrastructural upgradation of Bangladesh. India also agreed to construct the Akhaura-Agartala rail link, provide 250 megawatts per day from the Indian power grid and deferred plans to construct the 1500 MW Tipaimukh hydroelectric dam on the Barak in Manipur to which Bangladesh has reservations. It was also agreed that border markets would be set up along the Bangladesh-Meghalaya border and land customs posts on the Mizoram border. Forty-seven commodities were removed from the negative list, despite serious concern about the fallout. Bangladesh promised India access to the Ashuganj inland port and India, Nepal and Bhutan access to deep-water ports at Mongla and Chittagong. Bangladesh also expressed willingness to revive old land-border rail transit points and also prevent its soil from being used against India. Bangladesh also agreed to negotiate an extradition treaty, formation of a joint boundary group to address the land border and a team from Bangladesh to discuss maritime boundary. Sheikh Hasina expressed her satisfaction over the visit.

With Bhutan, India continues to nurture the good relation it had maintained for years. Earlier, in December 2009, the Bhutanese King Jigme Khesar Namgyel Wangchuck visited India and held wide-ranging talks with the Indian Prime Minister Manmohan Singh and both sides signed several pacts in different sectors. Again in 2010, the Indian Prime Minister Manmohan Singh held a bilateral meeting with Bhutanese King on the sidelines of 16th SAARC Summit in Kathmandu in April. Dr. Singh also laid the foundation stones of the India-funded state-of-the-art medical institute, two hydroelectricity plants and an IT project before returning to India after the three-day